



THREAT ADVISORY

**ACTOR
REPORT**

Is APT 42 a significant threat in the future?

Date of Publication

September 9, 2022

Admiralty code

A1

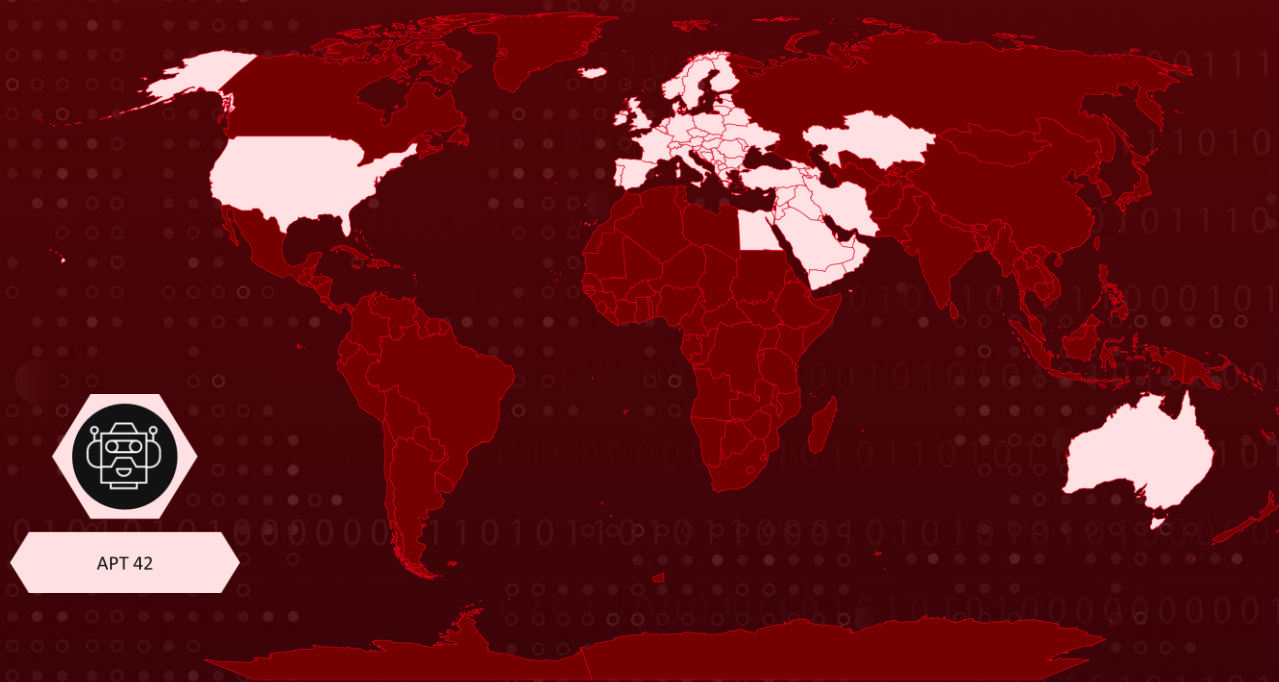
TA Number

TA2022197

Summary

APT42 is an Iranian state-sponsored cyber espionage group. The gang, which has been operating since at least 2015, is distinguished by its highly targeted spear phishing and surveillance operations targeting individuals and organizations in at least 14 countries.

Actor Map



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Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs

TA0042 Resource Development	T1583 Acquire Infrastructure	T1583.003 Virtual Private Server	T1584 Compromise Infrastructure
T1587 Develop Capabilities	T1587.003 Digital Certificates	T1588 Obtain Capabilities	T1588.004 Digital Certificates
TA0001 Initial Access	T1133 External Remote Services	T1566 Phishing	T1566.001 Spearphishing Attachment
T1566.002 Spearphishing Link	TA0002 Execution	T1047 Windows Management Instrumentation	T1059 Command and Scripting Interpreter
T1059.001 PowerShell	T1059.005 Visual Basic	T1059.007 JavaScript	T1569 System Services
T1569.002 Service Execution	T1204 User Execution	T1204.001 Malicious Link	T1204.002 Malicious File
TA0003 Persistence	T1098 Account Manipulation	T1098.002 Additional Email Delegate Permissions	T1133 External Remote Services
T1543 Create or Modify System Process	T1543.003 Windows Service	T1547 Boot or Logon Autostart Execution	T1547.001 Registry Run Keys / Startup Folder
T1547.004 Winlogon Helper DLL	TA0004 Privilege Escalation	T1055 Process Injection	T1134 Access Token Manipulation
TA0005 Defense Evasion	T1027 Obfuscated Files or Information	T1027.002 Software Packing	T1027.005 Indicator Removal from Tools
T1070 Indicator Removal on Host	T1070.004 File Deletion	T1112 Modify Registry	T1140 Deobfuscate/Decode Files or Information
T1221 Template Injection	T1497 Virtualization/Sandbox Evasion	T1497.001 System Checks	T1497.003 Time Based Evasion
T1564 Hide Artifacts	T1564.003 Hidden Window	TA0006 Credential Access	T1003 OS Credential Dumping
T1111 Multi-Factor Authentication Interception	TA0007 Discovery	T1012 Query Registry	T1016 System Network Configuration Discovery

T1082 System Information Discovery	T1083 File and Directory Discovery	T1087 Account Discovery	T1087.001 Local Account
T1518 Software Discovery	TA0008 Lateral Movement	T1021 Remote Services	T1021.001 Remote Desktop Protocol
T1021.004 SSH	TA0009 Collection	T1113 Screen Capture	T1115 Clipboard Data
T1123 Audio Capture	T1125 Video Capture	T1213 Data from Information Repositories	T1213.002 Sharepoint
T1560 Archive Collected Data	T1560.002 Archive via Library	TA0011 Command and Control	T1071 Web Protocols
T1071.001 Application Layer Protocol	T1071.002 File Transfer Protocols	T1095 Non-Application Layer Protocol	T1102 Web Service
T1105 Ingress Tool Transfer	T1132 Data Encoding	T1132.001 Standard Encoding	T1573 Encrypted Channel
T1573.002 Asymmetric Cryptographic	TA0010 Exfiltration	T1041 Exfiltration over C2 Channel	TA0040 Impact
T1529 System Shutdown/Reboot			

Technical Details

#1

APT42's recent operations in 2022 included hosting several malicious Office documents on open-source cloud-based storage systems in January and February, which resulted in the distribution of TABBYPAT and VBREVSHELL malware. Another series of malicious Office documents mimicking a reputable British news organization was distributed in February 2022 to get personal email credentials. In early March 2022, malicious PowerShell programs were distributed under the banners of unusual ports that capture data on a local host.

#2

APT 42's overall attack chain largely relies on spear phishing to execute an initial breach and is capable of intercepting MFA authentication codes via credential harvesting forms. After successfully authenticating to a victim's account and proceeds to employ a variety of lightweight malware such as BROKEYOLK, CHAIRSMACK, GHAMBAR, MAGICDROP, POWERPOST, and many others to maintain persistence, escalate privilege, and lateral movement.



Actor Detail

NAME	ORIGIN	TARGET LOCATIONS	TARGET INDUSTRIES
APT 42	Iran	Australia, United States, Ukraine, France, Spain, Sweden, Norway, Germany, Finland, Poland, Italy, United Kingdom, Romania, Belarus, Kazakhstan, Greece, Bulgaria, Iceland, Hungary, Portugal, , Serbia, Austria, Czechia, Ireland, Lithuania, Latvia, Croatia, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Slovakia, Estonia, Denmark, Switzerland, Netherlands, Moldova, Belgium, Albania, North Macedonia, Turkey, Slovenia, Montenegro, Kosovo, Azerbaijan, Georgia, Luxembourg, Andorra, Malta, Liechtenstein, San Marino, Monaco, Vatican City, Cyprus, Armenia, Akrotiri and Dhekelia, Bahrain, Cyprus, Egypt, Iran, Iraq, Israel, Jordan, Kuwait, Lebanon, Oman, Palestine, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, Syria, Turkey, United Arab Emirates, Yemen	Education, Governments, Healthcare, Legal, professional services, Manufacturing, Media, Pharmaceuticals
	MOTIVE		
	Information theft and espionage		



✂ Indicator of Compromise (IOC)

TYPE	VALUE
SHA-256	b9b783ad3bc523a031cdf799dd9739a7bcbcf184e7e64a0f3cc2170be4d4526f 7a650d3b1e511a05d0441484c7c7df59a63003ce77cd4eb7081323fd79d2b9a3 a37a290863fe29b9812e819e4c5b047c44e7a7d7c40e33da6f5662e1957862ab 7eb564f0afc23cc8186e67f8c0d7e6c80215b75c9f0c4b35f558a9e35743ca41 003676e6240421426e5c0919eb40bdde52b383eb1c54596deb77218c3885cdc5 2c33b1dd793ad5e59180719d078301ee7ebb6cf7465286c19b042accca6ac749 a485ef522a00edc7eb141f4ef982dd52b3e784ea8d8f1bb0ca044a61ce642eac
MD5	da7d37bfb899a0094995944d4c5e2f21 df02a8a7cb2afb80cc2b789d96f02715 3d67ce57aab4f7f917cf87c724ed7dab 04a6997f0a8021b773ebb49977bc625f 34d37f64613f3fe00086ac8d5972db89 8e0eb3ceb1bbe736beaf64353dda1908 63cd07e805bcd4135a8e3a29fa3ceebd 0a3f454f94ef0f723ac6a4ad3f5bdf01 Ae797446710e375f0fc9a33432d64256
SHA1	9624d9613fe8cdc6833888b9e68892565e3a5d11 03d7ffd758e98c9a2c8c4716c93f09687000e22e 470b850363677d3d54629a92ac8b5143f4584a09 3b9a2e34f5d603b55cf7fd223d4e5c784b805242 66d36d0b170cf1a0001cca16357961a2f28cba60 08d2aea84d6c148ff2ad4653856fb080eb99abf2 2374f5a9278b209563e8193847a76c25c12eec8f d08982960d71a101b87b1896fd841433b66c7262

✂ References

<https://www.mandiant.com/media/17826>

What Next?

Book a free demo with **HivePro Uni5** to check your exposure to this advisory. HivePro Uni5 is a Continuous Threat Exposure Management Solution that proactively reduces an organization's attack surface before it gets exploited.



At Hive Pro we take a long hard look at your vulnerabilities so you can bolster your defenses and fine-tune your offensive cybersecurity tactics.

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